

Corporate Strategy English

Participant workbook: strategic diagnosis, choices, market analysis, portfolio strategy, growth, M&A, uncertainty, governance, and executive dialogue practice

Audience: advanced ESL learners working in corporate strategy, business strategy, corporate development, transformation, strategic finance, internal consulting, product strategy, commercial strategy, and related roles

Focus: high-level professional English for corporate strategy workplaces, including strategic diagnosis, where-to-play and how-to-win choices, tradeoffs, industry structure, competitive advantage, portfolio strategy, resource allocation, growth strategy, M&A logic, uncertainty, scenarios, operating model, OKRs, executive narratives, and board-level dialogue.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who work in corporate strategy, business strategy, CEO office, transformation, corporate development, strategic finance, internal consulting, product strategy, commercial strategy, or strategy-adjacent leadership roles.

Teaching stance: corporate strategy English is the language of consequential choice. Learners need to frame ambiguous problems, make tradeoffs explicit, connect analysis to decisions, challenge attractive but incoherent ideas, and communicate uncertainty without sounding weak. This course teaches professional communication and judgment, not a single best strategy framework.

How to Use This Workbook

This workbook helps you sound precise and credible in corporate strategy conversations. The goal is not to use more frameworks. The goal is to connect ambiguity to choices, choices to evidence, evidence to resource allocation, and resource allocation to execution.

Your starting point

- Which strategy conversations are hardest for you: problem framing, market analysis, portfolio review, M&A challenge, executive pushback, scenario planning, board prep, or KPI governance?
- Which strategy terms do you understand when reading but avoid when speaking?
- When senior leaders ask for everything, do you become too agreeable, too analytical, too indirect, or too blunt?
- What is one recent strategy meeting you wish you had handled more clearly?

Use the guided dialogue activities below. Every item has four choices and a rationale in the answer key; no open-ended writing is required.

Corporate Strategy Workstream Language

Area	Useful verbs	Example sentence
Framing	diagnose, clarify, structure, hypothesize, prioritize	We should align on the decision question before building the model.
Choices	choose, focus, trade off, sequence, deprioritize	The strategy is not clear until the tradeoff is visible.
Markets	assess, segment, benchmark, map, pressure-test	The market is growing, but value capture may be structurally weak.
Portfolio	allocate, reallocate, fund, harvest, divest	Equal funding would preserve inertia rather than shift resources to the strongest thesis.
Growth	enter, build, buy, partner, integrate	The route to market depends on speed, control, capability gap, and risk.
Execution	govern, measure, escalate, sequence, operationalize	The dashboard should show movement in value drivers, not only initiative status.

Practice Pages

Module 1. Strategy Role, Problem Framing, and Executive Diagnosis

Corporate strategy work begins before analysis. Learners must frame the real decision, separate symptoms from causes, identify the executive audience, and define what would change if the analysis is persuasive.

What you should be able to do

- Distinguish problem statement, symptom, root cause, hypothesis, issue tree, decision question, recommendation, and implementation implication.
- Ask executive-level clarification questions without sounding junior or obstructive.
- Guided communication selection: choose the evidence, caveat, audience, and next action needed for a concise diagnosis that names the strategic tension rather than listing every fact

Three-step decision practice

Situation

The CEO asks the strategy team for a strategy, but the request sounds like a list of initiatives.

Speaker	Line
CEO	We need a strategy for next year. Give me the top twenty initiatives.
Strategy lead	We can build the initiative list, but first we need the strategic choice behind it.
ESL learner	If the output is only a project list, we may miss the real decision. Are we trying to defend the core, enter a new segment, improve margins, or shift resources toward higher-growth businesses?
CEO	All of the above.
ESL learner	Then the first decision is prioritization. We should define the few choices that matter most, the tradeoffs they imply, and the _____ that must move.

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

Then the first decision is prioritization. We should define the few choices that matter most, the tradeoffs they imply, and the _____ that must move.

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	resources
D	decision owner

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (The CEO asks the strategy team for a strategy, but the request sounds like a list of initiatives.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	operating constraint

Option	Phrase
D	Then the first decision is prioritization. We should define the few choices that matter most, the tradeoffs they imply, and the resources that must move.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (The CEO asks the strategy team for a strategy, but the request sounds like a list of initiatives.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	Treat urgency as sufficient evidence and commit before the review is complete.
B	Verify resources, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.
C	operating constraint
D	decision owner

Module 2. Strategic Choices: Ambition, Where to Play, How to Win, and Tradeoffs

A strategy is not a slogan or a project list. It is a set of choices about where the company will compete, how it will win, what capabilities it needs, and what it will not do.

What you should be able to do

- Use choice language for ambition, where to play, how to win, capabilities, systems, and management priorities.
- Explain tradeoffs without sounding negative or risk-averse.
- Identify whether an initiative supports the strategy or merely sounds attractive.

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A leadership team is debating whether to prioritize enterprise customers or mid-market customers.

Speaker	Line
CRO	Enterprise logos create credibility. We should focus there.
Product head	Mid-market customers adopt faster and need fewer custom features.
ESL learner	The where-to-play choice affects product roadmap, sales motion, implementation cost, pricing, and support model. Enterprise may increase contract value, but mid-market may improve velocity and margins.
CRO	Can we do both?
ESL learner	Possibly, but not with the same operating model. If we choose both, we need explicit segmentation and different service levels, not one vague _____.

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

Possibly, but not with the same operating model. If we choose both, we need explicit segmentation and different service levels, not one vague _____.

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	evidence threshold
C	approval path
D	strategy

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (A leadership team is debating whether to prioritize enterprise customers or mid-market customers.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	decision owner
C	I can approve the result now and look at strategy after the decision.

Option	Phrase
D	Possibly, but not with the same operating model. If we choose both, we need explicit segmentation and different service levels, not one vague strategy.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (A leadership team is debating whether to prioritize enterprise customers or mid-market customers.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	Treat urgency as sufficient evidence and commit before the review is complete.
B	Verify strategy, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.
C	operating constraint
D	decision owner

Module 3. Industry Structure, Competitive Dynamics, and Profit Pools

Attractive growth is not always attractive profit. Learners need language for industry structure, Five Forces, profit pools, competitor moves, barriers, substitutes, and shifting value capture.

What you should be able to do

- Discuss market attractiveness using Five Forces, profit-pool logic, growth, margin, cyclicity, regulation, and structural change.
- Explain why a growing market may still be strategically unattractive.
- Distinguish competitor activity from competitive advantage.

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A team wants to enter a fast-growing market but has not examined industry structure.

Speaker	Line
Business unit GM	The market is growing 18 percent. We should enter quickly.
Analyst	Growth is strong, but supplier power and buyer power are also high.
ESL learner	Market growth is attractive, but the profit pool may be weak. If buyers can switch easily, suppliers control key inputs, and substitutes are improving, growth may not translate into returns.
GM	So you are saying no?
ESL learner	Not necessarily. I am saying entry needs a clear position, a barrier we can build, and economics that survive competitive _____.

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

Not necessarily. I am saying entry needs a clear position, a barrier we can build, and economics that survive competitive _____.

Option	Phrase
A	pressure
B	evidence threshold
C	approval path
D	operating constraint

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (A team wants to enter a fast-growing market but has not examined industry structure.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	decision owner
C	I can approve the result now and look at pressure after the decision.

Option	Phrase
D	Not necessarily. I am saying entry needs a clear position, a barrier we can build, and economics that survive competitive pressure.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (A team wants to enter a fast-growing market but has not examined industry structure.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	Use broader jargon instead of making the risk and next action clear.
B	Verify pressure, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.
C	Treat urgency as sufficient evidence and commit before the review is complete.
D	Escalate the issue without first naming the decision, evidence gap, or accountable owner.

Module 4. Business Models, Unit Economics, Capabilities, and Advantage

Corporate strategy must explain how value is created, captured, defended, and scaled. Learners need to connect customer value, economics, capabilities, activities, and operating model.

What you should be able to do

- Use business-model and financial terms such as revenue model, gross margin, contribution margin, CAC, LTV, ROIC, WACC, DCF, NPV, and payback accurately.
- Explain strategic advantage in terms of activities, capabilities, cost position, differentiation, switching costs, data, distribution, brand, or scale.
- Challenge business cases that assume growth without credible economics or capabilities.

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A mature business funds the company, but a new opportunity needs investment.

Speaker	Line
Core BU leader	Our unit generates the cash. Cutting our budget will damage the business.
Innovation lead	Without investment, the new platform will miss the window.
ESL learner	The portfolio question is not which team deserves funding. It is what role each business plays. The core must remain healthy, but some resources may need to shift if the new platform is the stronger future value pool.
Core BU leader	That sounds like punishing performance.
ESL learner	I would frame it as funding enterprise value. We should define the minimum investment to protect the core and the incremental investment needed to test the new platform's _____.

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

I would frame it as funding enterprise value. We should define the minimum investment to protect the core and the incremental investment needed to test the new platform's _____.

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	thesis
C	evidence threshold
D	approval path

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (A mature business funds the company, but a new opportunity needs investment.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	I would frame it as funding enterprise value. We should define the minimum investment to protect the core and the incremental investment needed to test the new platform's thesis.
B	evidence threshold

Option	Phrase
C	approval path
D	operating constraint

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (A mature business funds the company, but a new opportunity needs investment.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	Verify thesis, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.
D	evidence threshold

Module 5. Portfolio Strategy, Capital Allocation, and Resource Reallocation

Corporate strategy often fails because resources do not move. Learners need language for portfolio roles, capital allocation, mature cash businesses, growth bets, divestitures, adjacency, opportunity cost, and management politics.

What you should be able to do

- Use portfolio terminology accurately: core, adjacency, horizon, business unit, capital allocation, resource reallocation, hurdle rate, divestiture, stranded cost, and opportunity cost.
- Discuss investment, hold, harvest, partner, acquire, divest, and exit recommendations.
- Push back when every business unit requests equal growth funding despite different economics and strategic roles.

Three-step decision practice

Situation

Every business unit requests a similar budget increase despite different performance and market opportunities.

Speaker	Line
CFO	Every BU is asking for 8 percent more. That is not a strategy.
BU leader	We all have growth plans.
ESL learner	Equal increases may feel fair, but they ignore opportunity cost. We should allocate based on market attractiveness, advantage, capital intensity, confidence in execution, and strategic role.
BU leader	My team will see that as a cut.
ESL learner	Then we need transparent decision rules. Some units may get growth capital, some may get productivity targets, and some may need option funding rather than full-scale _____.

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

Then we need transparent decision rules. Some units may get growth capital, some may get productivity targets, and some may need option funding rather than full-scale _____.

Option	Phrase
A	investment
B	evidence threshold
C	approval path
D	operating constraint

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (Every business unit requests a similar budget increase despite different performance and market opportunities.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	Let's avoid naming investment until the discussion is over.
B	Then we need transparent decision rules. Some units may get growth capital, some may get productivity targets, and some may need option funding rather than full-scale investment.
C	decision owner

Option	Phrase
D	I can approve the result now and look at investment after the decision.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (Every business unit requests a similar budget increase despite different performance and market opportunities.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	Use broader jargon instead of making the risk and next action clear.
B	Verify investment, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.
C	Treat urgency as sufficient evidence and commit before the review is complete.
D	Escalate the issue without first naming the decision, evidence gap, or accountable owner.

Module 6. Growth Strategy, Market Entry, Partnerships, and M&A Logic

Growth strategy requires a clear thesis: where growth will come from, why the company has a right to win, what route to market is credible, and whether to build, buy, partner, or wait.

What you should be able to do

- Use terms such as organic growth, inorganic growth, adjacency, market entry, beachhead, build-buy-partner, joint venture, strategic alliance, acquisition thesis, synergy, integration risk, and cannibalization.
- Explain why a market may be attractive but still not a good fit.
- Challenge unsupported M&A or partnership logic with questions about value creation, integration, control, culture, and downside risk.

Three-step decision practice

Situation

The company wants to enter an adjacent market but lacks several capabilities.

Speaker	Line
Corporate development	We can acquire a player and accelerate entry.
Operations	Integration could distract the organization for two years.
ESL learner	The route depends on speed, control, capability gap, integration risk, and economics. Build gives control but may be slow. Buy gives access but may overpay. Partner creates optionality but limits control.
CEO	What do you recommend?
ESL learner	Start with a partnership to validate demand and operating requirements, while screening acquisition targets if the thesis proves _____.

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

Start with a partnership to validate demand and operating requirements, while screening acquisition targets if the thesis proves _____.

Option	Phrase
A	attractive
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	decision owner

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (The company wants to enter an adjacent market but lacks several capabilities.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	Start with a partnership to validate demand and operating requirements, while screening acquisition targets if the thesis proves attractive.
B	I can approve the result now and look at attractive after the decision.

Option	Phrase
C	Let's avoid naming attractive until the discussion is over.
D	I disagree, but I cannot identify the evidence or condition that would change the decision.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (The company wants to enter an adjacent market but lacks several capabilities.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	decision owner
C	Verify attractive, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.
D	approval path

Module 7. Uncertainty, Scenarios, Strategic Options, and Risk Posture

A strong strategist does not pretend the future is certain. Learners need language for scenarios, residual uncertainty, trigger indicators, no-regrets moves, options, big bets, shaping, adapting, and reserving the right to play.

What you should be able to do

- Discuss uncertainty without sounding indecisive.
- Create scenario implications that change decisions, not decorative future stories.
- Recommend strategic moves based on uncertainty level, risk appetite, and trigger indicators.

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A deal team presents synergy estimates that sound optimistic.

Speaker	Line
Deal lead	The acquisition creates 60 million in annual synergies.
CFO	Where exactly do those synergies come from?
ESL learner	We should separate revenue synergies, cost synergies, tax or procurement benefits, and capability synergies. Each needs an owner, timing, one-time cost, and confidence level.
Deal lead	The revenue synergies are strategic.
ESL learner	Strategic is not enough. Which customers, which products, which channel, what attach rate, and what _____ tells us the combined company can capture it?

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

Strategic is not enough. Which customers, which products, which channel, what attach rate, and what _____ tells us the combined company can capture it?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence
B	decision owner
C	evidence threshold
D	approval path

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (A deal team presents synergy estimates that sound optimistic.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	Let's avoid naming evidence until the discussion is over.
B	Strategic is not enough. Which customers, which products, which channel, what attach rate, and what evidence tells us the combined company can capture it?
C	decision owner

Option	Phrase
D	I can approve the result now and look at evidence after the decision.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (A deal team presents synergy estimates that sound optimistic.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	Verify evidence, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.
C	Escalate the issue without first naming the decision, evidence gap, or accountable owner.
D	Use broader jargon instead of making the risk and next action clear.

Module 8. Execution Governance, Operating Model, KPIs, and Board Narrative

Strategy becomes real through operating model, decision rights, resource shifts, milestones, KPIs, governance, and narrative discipline. Learners must convert strategy into accountable execution without turning it into a long project inventory.

What you should be able to do

- Use execution terms such as operating model, governance, decision rights, initiative, roadmap, milestone, dependency, OKR, KPI, leading indicator, lagging indicator, value driver, and board narrative.
- Separate strategic KPIs from activity metrics.
- Build an executive or board storyline that names choices, evidence, risk, resource implications, and decisions needed.

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A new regulation could change the economics of a business model.

Speaker	Line
General counsel	We do not know how the rule will be finalized.
Strategy director	Then we need scenarios.
ESL learner	Let's build only scenarios that would change our decision. For each one, we need trigger indicators, financial impact, operational implications, and moves that are no-regrets across scenarios.
CEO	What can we do now?
ESL learner	We can reduce exposure in the highest-_____ product, invest in compliance capability, and create an option to shift the model if the strict scenario becomes more likely.

1. Complete the field language

Use the dialogue and the surrounding evidence to choose the precise term.

We can reduce exposure in the highest-_____ product, invest in compliance capability, and create an option to shift the model if the strict scenario becomes more likely.

Option	Phrase
A	risk
B	evidence threshold
C	approval path
D	operating constraint

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Choose the response that acknowledges pressure, names the real boundary, and keeps the decision moving.

In this situation (A new regulation could change the economics of a business model.), a stakeholder asks for an immediate answer. Which response is the strongest?

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	decision owner

Option	Phrase
C	We can reduce exposure in the highest-risk product, invest in compliance capability, and create an option to shift the model if the strict scenario becomes more likely.
D	approval path

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the next move that keeps the work controlled without creating unnecessary delay.

After this situation (A new regulation could change the economics of a business model.), what should the learner do next?

Option	Phrase
A	Verify risk, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	decision owner

Phrase Bank

Problem framing and diagnosis

- What decision will this analysis change?
- The issue is not only growth; it is whether the growth creates attractive returns.
- I would separate the symptom from the strategic cause.
- Before we build the model, we should align on the decision question.

Strategic choices and tradeoffs

- This is a choice, not just a priority statement.
- If we choose this segment, what are we explicitly not serving?
- The strategy becomes clearer when the tradeoff is visible.
- We can do both only if the operating model supports both.

Market and competitive analysis

- Market growth is attractive, but we need to test value capture.
- Which force puts the most pressure on industry profitability?
- The competitor move matters only if it changes economics, access, or customer behavior.
- The profit pool is shifting, but not necessarily toward us.

Portfolio and resource allocation

- Equal funding is not the same as strategic funding.
- What role should this business play in the enterprise portfolio?
- The resource shift should follow market attractiveness, advantage, and strategic fit.
- We should define the minimum investment to protect the core and the option funding for future growth.

Growth, M&A, and partnerships

- Attractive market does not automatically mean right to win.
- Build gives control, buy gives speed, and partner gives optionality.
- The synergy case needs source, timing, owner, cost, and confidence level.
- The acquisition thesis should explain why we are the best owner of the asset.

Uncertainty and executive communication

- The future is uncertain, but the decision does not have to be vague.
- Which trigger indicators would cause us to revisit the plan?
- This is a no-regrets move across the scenarios we tested.
- For the board, I would lead with the decision, recommendation, risk, and resource implication.

Answer Key and Rationale

Check each stage after completing the practice sequence. The rationale explains the decision skill the strongest response demonstrates.

1. CEO Request: 'We Need a Strategy' - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. resources	'resources' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

1. CEO Request: 'We Need a Strategy' - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Then the first decision is prioritization. We should define the few choices that matter most, the tradeoffs they imply, and the resources that must move.	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

1. CEO Request: 'We Need a Strategy' - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Verify resources, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.

2. Where-to-Play Debate: Enterprise vs Mid-Market - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. strategy	'strategy' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

2. Where-to-Play Debate: Enterprise vs Mid-Market - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Possibly, but not with the same operating model. If we choose both, we need explicit segmentation and different service levels, not one vague strategy.	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

2. Where-to-Play Debate: Enterprise vs Mid-Market - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Verify strategy, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.

3. Five Forces: Growth Does Not Mean Profit - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. pressure	'pressure' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

3. Five Forces: Growth Does Not Mean Profit - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Not necessarily. I am saying entry needs a clear position, a barrier we can build, and economics that survive competitive pressure.	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

3. Five Forces: Growth Does Not Mean Profit - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Verify pressure, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.

4. Portfolio Review: Protect the Core or Fund the New Bet - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. thesis	'thesis' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

4. Portfolio Review: Protect the Core or Fund the New Bet - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I would frame it as funding enterprise value. We should define the minimum investment to protect the core and the incremental investment needed to test the new platform's thesis.	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

4. Portfolio Review: Protect the Core or Fund the New Bet - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Verify thesis, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.

5. Resource Allocation: Everyone Wants Flat Growth - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. investment	'investment' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

5. Resource Allocation: Everyone Wants Flat Growth - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Then we need transparent decision rules. Some units may get growth capital, some may get productivity targets, and some may need option funding rather than full-scale investment.	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

5. Resource Allocation: Everyone Wants Flat Growth - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Verify investment, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.

6. Market Entry: Build, Buy, or Partner - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. attractive	'attractive' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

6. Market Entry: Build, Buy, or Partner - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Start with a partnership to validate demand and operating requirements, while screening acquisition targets if the thesis proves attractive.	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

6. Market Entry: Build, Buy, or Partner - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Verify attractive, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.

7. M&A Synergy Challenge - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. evidence	'evidence' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

7. M&A Synergy Challenge - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Strategic is not enough. Which customers, which products, which channel, what attach rate, and what evidence tells us the combined company can capture it?	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

7. M&A Synergy Challenge - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Verify evidence, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.

8. Scenario Planning: Regulatory Uncertainty - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. risk	'risk' is the precise language in this response. The other options are plausible workplace terms, but they do not fit this sentence's meaning and form. This is the precise term already used in the professional response. It fits both the grammar and the technical meaning.

8. Scenario Planning: Regulatory Uncertainty - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. We can reduce exposure in the highest-risk product, invest in compliance capability, and create an option to shift the model if the strict scenario becomes more likely.	The strongest response is specific about what must be checked and avoids either false certainty or vague resistance. This response protects the decision while still moving the conversation forward.

8. Scenario Planning: Regulatory Uncertainty - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Verify risk, name the decision owner, and state the evidence that would change the recommendation.	A practical next move connects a named fact to an owner and a condition for proceeding, revising, or escalating. This creates a bounded decision: a fact to verify, an accountable person, and a clear condition for action.